

AN ECLECTIC TECHNOLOGIES FOUNDATIONAL DEFINITION

FD-BR — The Broker

Foundational Definition: The Human-Judgment Role That Discharges a Bright Line’s Authorization Obligation, Its Pairing to a Line, the Competence That Qualifies It, and the Conditions Under Which Architecture May Stand in Its Place

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Designation: FD-BR **Family:** Foundational Definitions **Version:** 0.1 — DRAFT (initial mapping; companion to FD-BL v0.3 and FD-SBL v0.1) **Date:** August 2026 **Author:** Tim Roxey **Organization:** Eclectic Technologies **Audience:** Standards and policy reviewers; sector regulators; compliance officers and legal counsel; framework authors; individuals appointed to Command Broker or Influence Broker roles **Parent:** None. This instrument defines. See §2. **Companion root definitions:** FD-BL and FD-SBL — the Bright Lines whose §4.5 obligation a Broker discharges. FD-BR owns the Broker role-type; the Lines own the placement criteria that determine each Broker’s competence domain.

1. Purpose and the Defect This Instrument Corrects

Every Bright Line in the corpus creates an obligation: an action placed above the line requires substantive, attributable human authorization. The human who supplies that authorization is the Broker. The corpus already names two — the **Command Broker (CB)**, which authorizes above-line actions in industrial and control settings, and the **Influence Broker (IB)**, which authorizes above-line actions in the surveillance and democratic-process setting.

The roles exist but are not defined at the foundational level. They are currently introduced inside the Command Broker Framework, Cross-Sector, and elaborated in the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard — that is, *downstream* of the frameworks that consume them. Three defects follow.

First, a role defined inside a framework drifts with that framework. Each document that uses “the Broker” can restate it, and nothing binds the restatements together.

Second, the relationship between a Broker and a Bright Line has never been stated as an invariant. Because it is unstated, nothing prevents the category error of assuming one Broker role covers more than one Line — the error FD-SBL was written to guard against when it insisted a Command Broker is not an Influence Broker.

Third, the term itself varies: the surveillance corpus writes “Influence Broker,” while the CB-IB Qualification Standard writes “Influencer Broker.” Same role, two spellings, no reservation.

This instrument defines the Broker role-type once, states the Line↔Broker pairing invariant, fixes the competence and accountability rules, sets the conditions under which architecture may substitute for a Broker, names the two current instantiations, and reserves the term.

2. Authority, Family, and Convention

2.1 Precedence

This instrument owns the definition of the Broker for all documents in the corpus, across both the industrial (FD-BL) and democratic-safeguards (FD-SBL) lines.

Foundational Definitions take precedence over frameworks, qualification standards, sector documents, and implementation guidance. The Command Broker Framework, the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard, FD-BL §4.5, and FD-SBL §4.5 are restatements or implementations of the role defined here. A framework or qualification standard may specify a Broker's sector procedures, competency instruments, and disclosure architecture; it shall not vary the role definition (§4.1), the pairing invariant (§4.2), the competence rule (§4.3), the substitution rule (§4.4), or the accountability rule (§4.5). Propagation shall be by reference to this instrument, not by restating text.

2.2 The Foundational Definitions family

FD-BR qualifies under the family membership test: the correctness of both Bright Line documents and of the qualification standard depends on agreeing what kind of thing a Broker is. It is a root definition — it has dependents and no parent.

2.3 Declaration convention

Per the family convention, this instrument states what kind of thing the Broker is before defining it (§4.1): a role, not an office, not a component, not a procedure.

2.4 What this instrument does not alter

Nothing here alters the competency-assessment content, the disclosure architecture, or the onboarding mechanics carried in the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard, nor the sector procedures in the Command Broker Framework. Those are inherited unchanged. This instrument is definitional; it states requirements about the role and about conformance to it, not the operational content of any Broker's duties.

3. The Governing Questions

Identity. What kind of thing is a Broker?

Pairing. How does a Broker relate to a Bright Line?

Competence. What qualifies a specific human to hold a Broker role?

Substitution. When, if ever, may an architecture discharge the obligation in a Broker's place?

Accountability. Where does responsibility rest, and how is the Broker's independence secured?

The pairing and competence questions are the pair most often collapsed: a corpus that treats "Broker" as a single transferable credential has assumed all Lines share a placement criterion, which they do not.

4. The Definition

4.1 What kind of thing a Broker is

A Broker is a role: a qualified human who discharges the authorization obligation that a Bright Line places on above-line actions.

It is not an office, not a job title, not a software component, and not a procedure instructing someone to confirm. It is the human-judgment node in the enforcement triad — Line, Gate, Broker — where the Line places the obligation, the Gate is the architecture incapable of executing an above-line action without authorization, and the Broker is the human who authorizes. The Broker exists for one reason, inherited from FD-BL §4.5 and FD-SBL §4.5: to supply judgment where proof is unavailable. It is compensation for unverifiability, not a general requirement that consequential actions have human involvement.

4.2 The pairing invariant

For every Foundational Bright Line there is exactly one Broker role that discharges its §4.5 obligation. The Line and its Broker are two halves of one construct. The Line places the obligation; the Broker discharges it; neither is fully specified without the other. A corpus with N Bright Lines has N Broker roles. This is an invariant, not a convention: it holds whether or not a given framework names the Broker explicitly.

The two current instantiations:

Command Broker (CB) pairs with **FD-BL**, the industrial Bright Line. It authorizes above-line actions whose consequence is measured in facility severity.

Influence Broker (IB) pairs with **FD-SBL**, the Surveillance Bright Line. It authorizes above-line actions whose consequence is measured in harm to democratic self-governance and individual autonomy.

A future Bright Line in the family will generate its own Broker by this invariant; it does not inherit CB or IB.

4.3 Competence is set by the paired Line's placement criterion, and does not transfer

The competence required of a Broker is the competence to judge, on the merits, the actions placed above its Line.

Because placement criteria differ by Line (FD-BL places on facility consequence; FD-SBL on democratic-process consequence), the competence domains differ by Broker. A Command Broker must be competent in process and control consequence — able to evaluate what an incorrect setpoint or control action could cause. An Influence Broker must be competent in the behavioral- and social-science evaluation of influence — able to judge whether an action manipulates cognition, which is a materially different and, per FD-SBL §4.5, materially harder judgment.

Qualification is therefore Line-specific and non-transferable. Holding one Broker role does not qualify a person for another. A single human may hold two Broker roles only by satisfying both qualification standards independently. A proposal for one “Broker” credential spanning multiple Lines is rejected at the definitional level: it conflates the placement criteria the Line definitions exist to keep apart.

4.4 Substitution: when a Gate may stand in for the Broker

An architecture may discharge the obligation in the Broker's place only where the paired Line's environment is proof-bounded — where the correctness of a narrow, specified class of above-line actions can be proven in advance, over state, trajectory, and rate, in a deterministic and formally verified gatekeeper the proposer cannot modify or bypass. This is the FD-BL-D1 condition (R1–R3), and it is what makes advance discharge defensible in the industrial case: a protective function's behavior is bounded by proof, so judgment is not required where proof is available.

Where the environment is not proof-bounded — where an above-line action's harm cannot be verified even in principle — no Gate can stand in, and the Broker's in-the-moment judgment is mandatory. This

is the surveillance case: FD-SBL §6.1 records that manipulative influence is by design subtle and camouflaged, so there is no verifiable signal a gatekeeper could certify against. Substitutability is therefore a property of the paired Line, and it is a spectrum, not a switch. The Command Broker is partially substitutable by a verified gatekeeper for pre-proven action classes; the Influence Broker is, pending the FD-SBL §6.1 determination, not substitutable. The degree of Line↔Broker coupling is tighter wherever verification is weaker. Each Line document shall state its own substitutability value; this instrument owns the rule that sets it.

4.5 Accountability and independence

Authorization by a Broker shall be substantive and attributable. Substantive means the Broker has the information, competence, time, and authority to withhold authorization on the merits. Attributable means the authorization resolves to a named qualified individual and is reconstructable from the audit record.

Accountability for an authorized action rests with the named human Broker and with the deploying authority. No software component holds it. A supplier may build and operate the enforcement architecture; a supplier may not hold the accountability.

Independence is a per-domain design constraint, set by the incentive structure of the paired domain. Where the deploying authority's interest is aligned with correct placement — the ordinary Command Broker case in a commercial or utility setting — procedural independence may suffice. Where the deploying authority benefits from the above-line action — the Influence Broker case, in which the government running an influence operation is also the party the Broker must be able to refuse — independence must be structural, not procedural. Each Broker's qualification standard shall state its independence requirement, and shall justify it from the domain's incentive structure rather than assert it.

5. Worked Examples

These examples are illustrative and interchangeable.

A generative optimizer nominates a setpoint above the line on a gas processing train. The Command Broker, competent in process consequence, authorizes on the merits. For a pre-proven class of nominations inside a fixed operating band whose setback was established by human authority in advance, a verified gatekeeper may discharge the obligation instead (§4.4, FD-BL-D1). The CB is substitutable here.

An AI system autonomously targets a voter with content tailored to her behavioral profile — an above-line action under FD-SBL. The Influence Broker, competent in the behavioral-science evaluation of manipulation, must authorize in the moment. No gatekeeper can certify in advance that the content is non-manipulative, because manipulation here is undetectable by design (§4.4, FD-SBL §6.1). The IB is not substitutable.

A person qualified and serving as a Command Broker is asked to sit as an Influence Broker. Absent independent qualification against the IB competence domain, the person is not qualified; process-consequence competence does not carry over to influence judgment (§4.3).

A vendor proposes a single "Broker" credential that covers both industrial and influence deployments. The proposal is rejected at the definitional level: it assumes one placement criterion where there are two (§4.2, §4.3).

A framework specifies that the deploying agency appoints the Influence Broker from its own staff. The specification fails the independence rule (§4.5): in a domain where the deploying authority benefits from the above-line action, the Broker's independence must be structural.

6. Reserved and Determined Items

6.1 Term reservation — resolved here

“Broker” is reserved for the role-type. “Command Broker (CB)” and “Influence Broker (IB)” are reserved for the two current instantiations. The variant “Influencer Broker” appearing in the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard is non-canonical and shall be conformed to “Influence Broker” at that instrument's next revision. Conformance is staged per instrument revision, following the reservation model used for “Bright Line” and for “envelope” (FD-EV).

6.2 Substitutability determinations — carried by the Line documents

The Command Broker's substitutability is governed by FD-BL-D1. The Influence Broker's substitutability is reserved pending the FD-SBL §6.1 indication-integrity determination. This instrument owns the substitution rule (§4.4); the per-Line values are owned by the Line documents and bind here by reference.

6.3 Dual-role holding — reserved

Whether, and under what conflict-of-interest constraints, a single human may hold two Broker roles simultaneously. The §4.3 rule permits it only on independent qualification against each; the additional question of whether simultaneous holding creates an impermissible conflict in specific deployment structures is reserved.

7. Conformance

Command Broker Framework, Cross-Sector (v0.1) — currently the definitional home of the CB and IB roles. Re-scope: the role-type is defined here; the framework becomes an implementing document that cites FD-BR and carries sector procedure only.

CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard (v0.1) — conforming in substance; it already treats both roles as a unified requirement. Update the term “Influencer Broker” to “Influence Broker” (§6.1) and cite FD-BR as the governing role definition.

FD-BL §4.5 and FD-SBL §4.5 — retain their domain-specific competence, substitutability, and independence content as restatements; add a reference to FD-BR as the source of the role-type and the pairing invariant.

Surveillance corpus (Influence Broker architecture; Federal AI Influence Oversight Officer materials) — cite FD-BR; conform “Influence Broker” usage and derive the structural-independence requirement from §4.5.

The detailed diagnosis and replacement text for each instrument belong in the conformance schedule and are not reproduced here.

8. Author Decisions Outstanding

Confirmation of the designation **FD-BR** and of its filing with the Foundational Definitions family (Project 0 / Cross-Project Alignment) alongside FD-BL, FD-SBL, FD-LD, and FD-EV.

Confirmation of the canonical term. This draft reserves **Influence Broker** over “Influencer Broker,” on the grounds that it matches the surveillance corpus and reads as a role rather than a description of a person; the CB-IB Qualification Standard would change, not the surveillance documents.

Confirmation that substitutability is stated as a *rule* here and as a *per-Line value* in each Line document (§4.4, §6.2), rather than being owned wholly by either side.

9. Foundational References

FD-BL — *The Bright Line*. Version 0.3. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

FD-SBL — *The Surveillance Bright Line*. Version 0.1. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

Command Broker Framework, Cross-Sector. Version 0.1. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

Command Broker / Influence Broker Qualification and Onboarding Standard (CB-IB). Version 0.1. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

Roxey, T.E. *The Surveillance Bright Line*. Version 2.2. Eclectic Technologies, 2026.

Kilger, M. Reviewer comments on Surveillance Bright Line US Companion V2.2, 2026. (Domain source for the §4.3 Influence-Broker competence requirement (c24) and the §4.5 structural-independence requirement (c26).)

Revision History

0.1 — August 2026. Initial draft. Lifts the Broker from a framework-level role to a Foundational Definition. Declares the Broker a role that discharges a Bright Line’s §4.5 obligation (§4.1); states the Line↔Broker pairing invariant and names Command Broker↔FD-BL and Influence Broker↔FD-SBL (§4.2); sets competence by the paired Line’s placement criterion and makes qualification non-transferable (§4.3); owns the substitution rule under which a verified Gate may stand in for a Broker only in a proof-bounded environment, with the CB partially substitutable and the IB not (§4.4); makes independence a per-domain constraint set by incentive structure (§4.5); and reserves “Broker,” “Command Broker,” and “Influence Broker,” conforming the CB-IB Standard’s “Influencer Broker” (§6.1).